

1. Quoting D. Richard Hipp

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-29T21:15:21+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/29/d-richard-hipp/#atom-everything>

Years ago, we didn't have SQL. There were people whose job was to generate software that would query large data sets. Their job title was COBOL programmer. Then SQL comes along?I'm simplifying this only a little bit?and it gives you this convenient way so people could just specify. With a very simple specification, you can generate all of that code that you had to pay the expensive COBOL programmer to do before. That didn't mean programmers went away. It just meant the job changed a little bit. ? D. Richard Hipp Tags: d-richard-hipp , sql , careers

2. AI Worming through Word

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-29T18:43:03+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/29/ai-worming-through-word/#atom-everything>

AI Worming through Word Neat new prompt injection variant by Håkon Måly, who found a way to upgrade prompt injection attacks against Microsoft Word to full self-replicating worms: An attacker places hidden instructions in a document that is later used as source material in Copilot for Word. Copilot may interpret those instructions as part of the user's request, causing it to manipulate the document being drafted or edited. Copilot may then also copy the hidden instructions into the resulting document, turning that document into a new carrier. If the carrier is subsequently used in another Copilot-assisted workflow, the instructions can trigger again and propagate into further documents, even without the attacker's original document being present. We've seen plenty of hidden white-on-white text before - the kids are using it in their job applications now - but this is the first one I've seen that deliberately copies instructions to self-replicate itself. It was responsibly disclosed to Microsoft who then had 144 days to work on a fix, but so far (unsurprisingly) there's no mitigation that covers the full class of attack. Via Hacker News Tags: microsoft , security , ai , prompt-inj...

3. Quoting Matthew Green

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-29T18:18:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/29/matthew-green/#atom-everything>

Right now we're in the midst of a historic transition from traditional public-key algorithms based on EC-based cryptography and RSA, moving over to new post-quantum algorithms based on novel problems. This is why there are so many standards like HAWK being considered. If there was ever a perfect time for a massive new public cryptanalysis capability to come on line, we're in it. So unless AIs succeed in undermining all of our hard problems altogether (or we live in Impagliazzo's Minicrypt) then this could not be a better time for AI to get good at cryptanalysis. In the best case, the result is that we gain real confidence in the problems we've identified, and the cryptanalysis literature gets a lot more robust. Hopefully. ? Matthew Green , on Anthropic's recent cryptography work Tags: anthropic , claude , generative-ai , cryptography , ai , llms , ai-security-research , claude-mythos-fable

4. Superlogical

Source: Mitchell Hashimoto | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://mitchellh.com/writing/superlogical>

(No summary)

5. Apple Says iOS 27 'Restricted Mode' Isn't for Users Who Miss Payments in New Apple Upgrade Program

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-29T20:56:33Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/07/28/apple-says-ios-27-restricted-mode-isnt-for-new-upgrade-program-leases/>

Last week 9to5Mac reported on code in the latest iOS 27 developer beta seemingly meant to restrict leased devices after the user had missed one or more payments. When engaged, Restricted Mode limits the device to the following apps: Accessibility Reader App Store Health Magnifier Phone Clock Settings Wallet Passwords And some limited access to apps like Messages or health-related apps that might have critical messages. Many people reasonably speculated that this feature was related to Apple Upgrade, Apple's new device leasing partnership with Klarna, which Mark Gurman spoiled a few weeks ago. But an Apple spokesman confirmed to Emma Roth at The Verge today that "There will be no restricted mode and/or there will be no limitations put on device functionality due to missed payments or default with the Apple Upgrade program." Writing again today, here's 9to5Mac's Marcus Mendes : Apple, however, did not tell The Verge what Restricted Mode is intended for. One possibility is that it was developed for financing programs offered by carriers, retailers, or other partners outside Apple Upgrade, potentially including markets where device restrictions are already used to enforce installment...

6. Apple Upgrade ? New Program With Klarna for Leasing iPhones, Macs, iPads, and More for Near-Zero Interest

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-29T16:51:15Z

Link: <https://www.apple.com/newsroom/2026/07/apple-upgrade-launches-in-the-united-states/>

Apple Newsroom: Apple today announced Apple Upgrade , a new product leasing program provided by Klarna for iPhone, Apple Watch, Mac, and iPad available on the Apple Store online, in the Apple Store app, and at Apple Store locations in the United States. Apple Upgrade makes it even easier for customers to get the Apple products they love with a leasing plan that is right for them. [...] Apple Upgrade offers 12- and 24-month leasing options for iPhone and Apple Watch, and 24- and 36-month leasing options for Mac and iPad. Leasing prices start as low as \$17.99 per month for iPhone, \$11.99 for Apple Watch, \$24.99 for Mac, and \$11.99 for iPad. When customers first enroll in Apple Upgrade, they can further lower their monthly lease payments by trading in their currently owned device through Apple Trade In . Customers can also earn 3 percent Daily Cash back when making their lease payments with Apple Card. Michael Tsai , quoting Juli Clover at MacRumors: Juli Clover : The payoff amount is the difference between what was paid during the leasing period and the retail price of the device, minus any remaining trade-in credits. Klarna is not charging a fee for the leasing program, so an iPhone...

7. Pastebot 3

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-29T16:07:03Z

Link: <https://tapbots.com/pastebot/>

New from Tapbots: version 3 of their excellent clipboard manager for Mac. There are so many clipboard managers for the Mac. I run two other apps ? Keyboard Maestro and LaunchBar ? that offer good clipboard managers as ancillary features. But for years now I've chosen to use Pastebot. Chief among my favorite features: Remembers up to 1,500 clippings (up from a mere 1,000 in v2). Syncs via iCloud. If I copy something on one Mac, it's in my Pastebot history on my others Macs. That sweet Tapbots UI. Pastebot 3 requires MacOS 26 Tahoe or later. That means I'm only using it on secondary Macs for now ? my primary workstation will continue running MacOS 15 Sequoia until I upgrade directly to 27 Golden Gate later this year. But iCloud sync continues to work between Pastebot 2 and 3. New features include more powerful filters (e.g. you can use a filter to copy a URL and then paste that URL in Markdown's link syntax), a CLI tool (as yet undocumented), and Shortcuts support. \$39 for a license via direct purchase, with a \$13 discount for users of previous versions. It's still pending approval in the Mac App Store, where it will cost \$25/year or \$3/month. ?

8. Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 8

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260729-00/?p=112570>

Exceptions hiding in lambda captures. The post Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 8 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 7

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 28 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260728-00/?p=112568>

Further explorations into exception safety. The post Making an agile version of a Windows Runtime delegate in C++/WinRT, part 7 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Why do OpenAI's GPT-2 weights beat mine?

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 15:30:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilestomas.com/2026/07/why-do-openai-gpt2-weights-beat-mine-1-intro>

When I finished my project training an LLM from scratch , I was left with a minor mystery. Why were my models worse at instruction-following than the original OpenAI GPT-2 small weights? I had an evaluation that I was running, based on the instruction fine-tuning code in chapter 7 of " Build a Large Language Model (from Scratch) ". The process was to train a model on samples from the Alpaca instruction-following dataset until validation loss started rising, to use that instruction fine-tuned model to generate completions to a held-back test set, and then to use an LLM to compare the results from various different models. The details are here ; let's call it the IFT eval. OpenAI's original weights for GPT-2 small consistently beat my own models, even when mine got better results than theirs on a more technical evaluation, where I just measured the cross entropy loss for each model on a held-back set of test sequences. This surprised me; I would have expected a reasonably close correlation between the two evals -- that better test loss would imply better instruction-following. I have a couple of thoughts about why this might be, and given that I recently set up poppy , my dedicated...

11. Logic for Programmers is Done

Source: Computer Things | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 15:43:52 +0000

Link: <https://buttondown.com/hillelwayne/archive/logic-for-programmers-is-done/>

It's done. Logic for Programmers is now 1.0 and available in print. Full announcement here , official website here , direct Amazon link here . If you got an early version of the ebook, you can go back to leanpub to download the 1.0 for free. This marks the completion of a project that took five years of work, six bookwriting professionals, fourteen domain experts, and fifteen public alphas. This has been, without a doubt, the biggest and most exhausting project I've ever done. The examples in the discarded drafts alone could make a second book. The cursed knowledge I've gained on LaTeX and typography could fill a third (or at least a couple of entertaining blog posts). Self-publishing was simultaneously the worst and best decision I made. Now excuse me I am going to sleep for a month.

12. Why compute might get 10x+ more expensive in coming years

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 15:01:35 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/why-compute-might-get-10x-more-expensive>

If a human-level software engineer that could run on an H100 equivalent, at current market rates for software engineers, that H100 should rent for over \$250k a year. That's 15x today's spot price.

13. AI: Overwegingen voor wie erover gaat

Source: Bert Hubert's writings | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 15:20:00 +0200

Link: <https://berthub.eu/articles/posts/ai-voor-wie-erover-gaat/>

Onlangs presenteerde ik kort na elkaar bij het Netwerk van Publieke Dienstverleners en bij de Adviesraad Wetenschap, Technologie en Innovatie over AI. In deze twee verschillende maar korte presentaties hoopte ik wat inzichten te delen die nuttig zijn voor mensen die nu aan het stuur zitten, mensen die keuzes kunnen of moeten maken over AI-beleid. Dank aan NPD en AWTI voor de uitnodigingen en de stimulerende discussies! Dit artikel is gebaseerd op deze twee verschillende presentaties.

14. Pluralistic: Enshittification and Reverse Centaurs go global (29 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 29 Jul 2026 08:09:34 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/29/la-la-la-la-la/>

Today's links Enshittification and Reverse Centaurs go global: The good globalism. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Fonz thumps x Linux; CBC v DRM; Aussie mall v photos; English town x CCTVs; Pay no taxes x Big Tech; Games Workshop v gamers; Delta x surveillance pricing. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest.

Enshittification and Reverse Centaurs go global (permalink) It's safe to say that the past couple of years have been good ones for me publishing-wise, thanks to a string of international bestsellers, both novels (Picks and Shovels) and nonfiction (Enshittification, Reverse Centaur), as well as plenty of awards and accolades: <https://craphound.com/shop> Over the past two months, I've won the Locus Award (Enshittification), had a NYT bestseller (Reverse Centaur), gotten a word in the OED ("enshittification"), and had the number one bestselling nonfiction paperback in Canada for more than a month running (Reverse Centaur). I also turned 55 ? a...